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THE PEOPLE'S CODE the DOCUMENTARY Executive Producers and Creators: ANA PAULA VALDOVINOS & VANESSA CIANGHEROTTI Directed by: COIZTA GRECKO Screenplay and Edited by: GABRIELA RETES Photography by: CESAR OMAR PÉREZ Original Score: VAITA SOSA & JULIÁN ANDRÉ A production MADE IN MEXICO, September 2025



THE PEOPLE'S CODE

Documentary | 53:40 | Mexico

INTRODUCTION

The People's Code was conceived and brought to life by producers Ana Paula Valdovinos and Vanessa Ciangherotti, who aimed to create a film that not only captures technological innovation but also honors the human stories of resilience, collaboration, and the courage to imagine a more equitable world.

Their approach was hands-on, developing the story, assembling the crew, and guiding the production with a focus on authenticity, ethical engagement, and international relevance.

This project is, above all, the result of their commitment to socially conscious storytelling and their belief that documentary cinema can illuminate hidden systems of power while celebrating the creativity and agency of the communities at its heart.

LOGLINE

A **German programmer** and a **Mixtec activist** collaborate to confront centuries of economic exclusion, creating open-source financial tools that empower Indigenous and marginalized communities while defying entrenched systems of power.

SYNOPSIS

Set in Mexico, **The People's Code** follows the unexpected partnership between a visionary **German programmer** and a **Mixtec activist** who come together to confront centuries of economic exclusion. Their collaboration gives rise to open-source financial tools designed to empower **Indigenous** and marginalized communities, offering an alternative to the systems that have long profited from their isolation.

As their work expands across Indigenous territories, new possibilities—and new tensions—begin to emerge. What started as an effort to build alternative financial tools gradually reveals a broader struggle over access, autonomy, and the right of communities to reshape the systems that have long kept them on the margins.

THEMES

Financial Inclusion

Indigenous Rights

Migration

Power & Remittances

Technology & Innovation

Education & Grants

Economic Justice

FILM APPROACH

Producer's Note

The People's Code emerged from our shared interest in exploring how technology intersects with social justice and economic access in marginalized territories. As producers, we were drawn to the collaboration between technologists and Indigenous organizers working to reimagine financial infrastructure from the ground up.

Developed with the support of the Interledger Foundation, the project allowed us to follow initiatives unfolding across Mexico, where open technologies, community knowledge, and collective organization converge. Our goal was not only to document an innovative technological movement—one that could fundamentally reshape how remittances flow between the United States and Mexico, allowing families to receive money directly, without intermediaries—but also to capture the human stories and cultural perspectives shaping it.

— Ana Paula Valdovinos & Vanessa Ciangherott

Producers

DIRECTOR'S STATEMENT

The People's Code begins with a simple but urgent question: who writes the rules of money? For decades, the global financial system has excluded millions of people—entire communities living and working outside institutions that were never designed for them.

In different regions of Mexico, however, new possibilities are emerging. Community microbanks, collective savings networks, and digital infrastructures are beginning to intersect with long-standing traditions of mutual aid. In these spaces, technological sovereignty and community-based economies are not abstract ideas but practical tools for survival and autonomy.

As a filmmaker, my interest was not only to document an alternative financial model, but to witness how innovation can emerge from historically marginalized territories, where Indigenous communities and grassroots organizers are redefining how value circulates and who gets to participate.

More than a film about financial inclusion and technology, The People's Code is a story about collective imagination and resistance—about communities that, from the margins of the system, are beginning to rewrite the rules of money and imagine new possibilities for the future.

— Coizta Grecko B

CREATIVE TEAM



Ana Paula Valdovinos CREATOR / PRODUCER

A two-time International Emmy® nominee with more than 25 years of experience in the development and production of audiovisual content for Mexico, Spain and the U.S. Hispanic market, she has received several international honors, including the New York Festivals TV & Film Awards.

Ana Paula has produced series and documentaries for Netflix, HBO Max, Peacock, NBCUniversal and Telemundo. She previously served as Vice President of Production & Development at Telemundo International Studios and as Head of Production & Development at Buendía Estudios in Spain.

She has led the development and production of projects such as ***El Recluso*** (Netflix, 2017 – International Emmy® nominee), ***No Te Puedes Esconder*** (Netflix, 2019 – International Emmy® nominee), and NBN – ***Natural Born Narco*** (Roku, 2021).

Most recently, she created and produced ***El Código de la Gente Vol. 1 México***, a documentary exploring technology, access, and financial inclusion.



Vanessa Ciangherotti

CREATOR / PRODUCER

Director, Writer, Producer, Screenwriter and Actress, trained in theatre and descendant of the Soler dynasty — a family of actors, directors, producers and writers who have remained active for over a century, with a remarkable presence in the Mexican entertainment industry.

With more than three decades of experience, she has received two **Premio Ariel** awards and the **Diosa de Plata**, and has written, directed, and produced over 1,900 hours of television.

As writer and director, she made the feature documentary ***HC68 – Heberto Castillo y el 68*** (2021), which explores Mexico's 1968 student movement through the role of engineer and social leader Heberto Castillo Martínez, engaging younger audiences through a contemporary narrative approach.

She founded **Ganthä**, Creative House of Content & Literary Development, dedicated to developing authentic and emotionally resonant stories.

Her recent work includes the creation and production of ***The People's Code Vol. 1 Mexico***, a documentary exploring technology as an act of resistance and a human bridge for marginalized communities.



Coizta Grecko B

DIRECTOR

Mexican filmmaker whose work explores the intersection of territory, memory, social justice and human rights, blending journalistic research, aesthetic exploration and ethical commitment.

Since 2014, as part of **Ojos de Perro vs la Impunidad**, his work has focused on structural violence and impunity in Mexico.

His films include ***Mirar Morir***, ***The Army on the Night of Iguala*** (LASA Award for Merit in Film), ***No se mata la verdad*** (Audience Award, Festival Viva México, Paris), ***Camila: La justicia posible***, nominated for the Gabriel García Márquez Journalism Award and winner of the Walter Reuter Journalism Prize in Germany. ***Este arte que abraza***, and in 2025, ***The People's Code Vol. 1 Mexico***.

His work is recognized for investigative rigor, ethical engagement, and a strong international presence in contemporary documentary.



Gabriela Retes

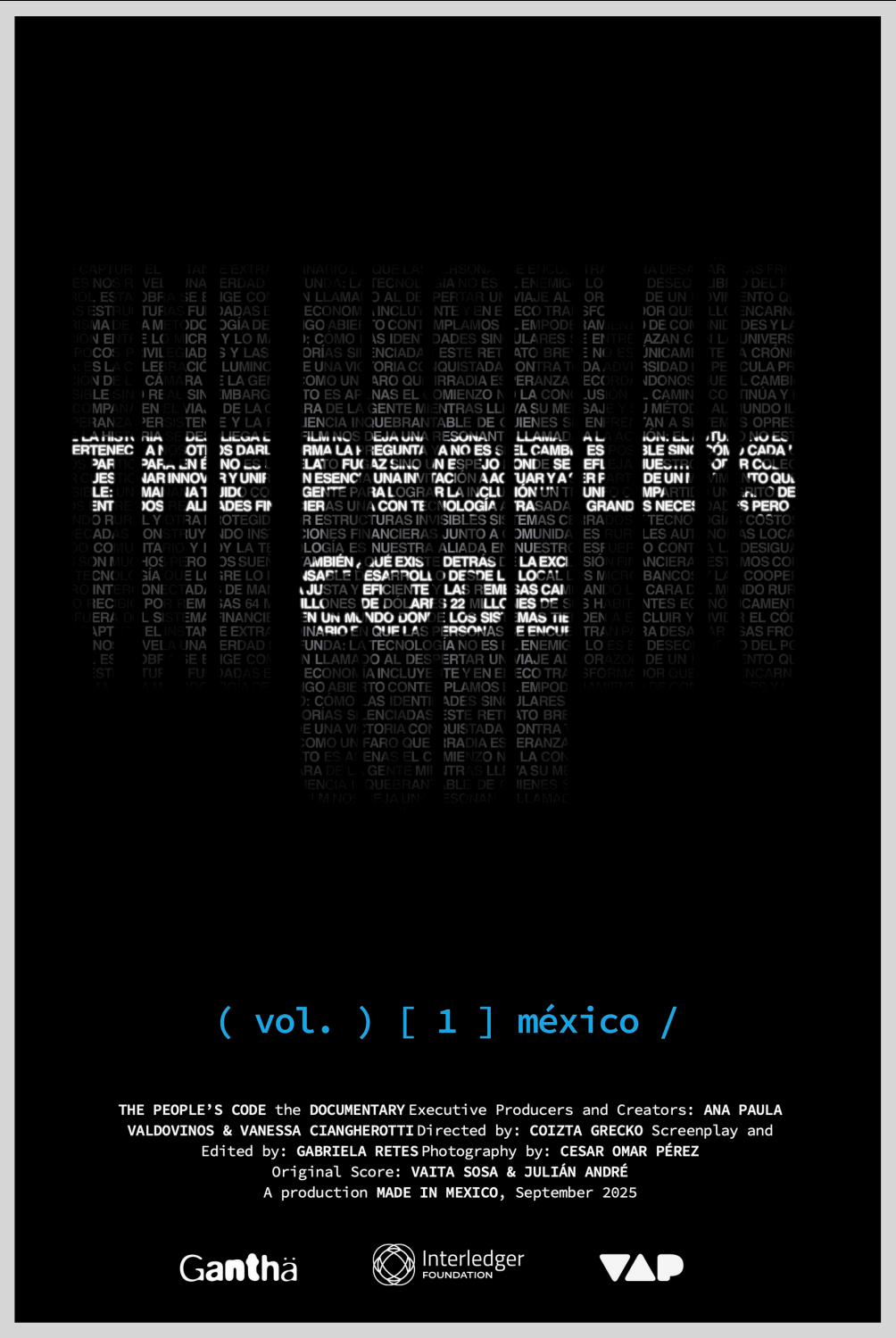
WRITER / EDITOR

Writer, director and editor whose work explores storytelling, education and the complexity of human relationships across fiction and documentary cinema.

She co-wrote the award-winning films ***El Bulto and Bienvenido–Welcome***, the latter receiving an **Ariel** nomination and the **Diosa de Plata**. Her short film ***La Luz de la Oscuridad*** premiered at the Guadalajara International Film Festival and received a Special Jury Mention at the Morelia International Film Festival.

Her recent work includes writing the documentary ***Camila: La justicia posible***, nominated for the Gabriel García Márquez Journalism Award and winner of the Walter Reuter Journalism Prize in Germany, as well as editing the documentary feature ***No se mata la verdad***.

Most recently, she wrote and edited ***The People's Code Vol. 1 Mexico*** and is currently completing the documentary ***Terramar, la escuela desobediente***, based on her decade of work in arts-based education.



Producers:
Ana Paula Valdovinos & Vanessa Ciangherotti

Director:
Coizta Grecko B

Writer & Editor
Gabriela Retes

Cinematography
Cesar Omar Pérez

Original Score:
Vaita Sosa & Julián André

Country:
Mexico

Language:
Spanish/English

Runtime:
53:40

Completion Year :
September 2025

TECHNICAL INFORMATION

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Una Producción de

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En asociación con

